

from around the world. What's more, CloudFlare is free to use, and it also has paid plans for more serious businesses who don't want to compromise with their website's security and reliability.

While CloudFlare is the most popular free CDN out there (even the Pirate Bay uses it!), there are alternatives like InCapsula, Myra Cloud and CDNify that are also worth looking into.

Hack your website (before someone else does)

OK, so you're not a hacker. We get that. And learning how to hack in meticulous detail will take time. We get that, too. But think how a hacker would – he or she wouldn't really go out trying to hack a website from scratch, without gathering some early vulnerability report, would they? That would be madness, if they did that! You need to do something similar to your website, find out all the chinks in its armour before the bad guys do.

Just like you can download a piece of software onto your PC or smartphone and test it for viruses and vulnerabilities, similarly you can run malware and vulnerability scanners on your web host to readily find a gaping hole or loose brick in its defensive wall. This step's important, because without this you're essentially in the dark, and won't know what steps to take to reinforce your website's defence.

Wapiti (<http://dgit.in/WapitiFzr>) is an open-source fuzzer, and a good place to start testing your website's security. Although a couple of years old, Wapiti tries to inject code into a website (through pages or forms) without thoroughly detecting its CMS. Another neat online tool used to audit a website's security is ScanMyServer (<http://dgit.in/ScnMySrvr>). It offers a vast and comprehensive report on a variety of parameters of security testing – SQL Injection, Cross Site Scripting, PHP Code and HTTP Header Injection, and lots more. Detectify (<http://dgit.in/detectify>) and SUCURI (<http://dgit.in/SucuriSite>) are other great website vulnerability testing tools available for your benefit, performing hundreds of automated tests to give you a robust report on your website's security status. Do act on the findings of these online vulnerability scanning tools!

Backup without fail

An oft-overlooked aspect of running or managing your own blog or website is taking regular off-server backup of your CMS' directory files. Why? Because when push comes to shove, and your site gets hacked against all odds, at least you can restore it back to some immediate point in the past, and not